

Build Local Links by Sponsoring Nonprofits

Objective

A live link from a local nonprofit's site to your client, a social mention from the nonprofit, and your own post tying the two together. Nonprofit sites rarely change, so the link tends to hold, and you reach their local audience.

"Most of them last over a year anyway, because they're not-for-profits. They're not going to be updating their websites too much." - Josh Shankowsky, Snap SEO

Key Steps

1. **List nonprofits in the service area.** Little leagues, community leagues, charities, food banks. Use ZipLocal's sponsorship database, or give an AI browser agent your criteria and budget.
2. **Check for a sponsor page and an active social account.** (inferred)
3. **Set the budget and make the ask up front:** a donation in return for a link from their website and a social mention.
4. **Donate** and confirm in writing where the link and mention will appear. (inferred)
5. **Publish your own blog and social post** about the sponsorship, for the client and for the agency.
6. **Offer help beyond the check:** outreach, collateral or ads. US 501(c)(3)s can apply for Google Ad Grants.
7. **Log the link and check it every quarter.** (inferred)

Cautionary Notes

- Pick causes the client would support anyway. It is public.
- The mention and your own post are part of the play.
- Sponsor pages move when a nonprofit rebuilds. Check on a schedule.

Tips for Efficiency

- Build one list per city and work it for every client there.
- Watch for the upsell: one sponsorship became a Google Ads client.
- Pair it with citation work for a stronger local entity.

Source: Josh Shankowsky, Snap SEO, on the Unscripted SEO Podcast with Jeremy Rivera (September 2026). Full breakdown at seoarcade.com · episode at unscriptedseo.com. Steps marked (inferred) are execution detail added by SEO Arcade.